

Tobias Treppmann

Head of Design System — the brand delivered by the system, and a build that refuses work which has left it

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PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where the design system is mine. DTCG tokens in four tiers, built to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source, enforced by the build rather than by review — the people building with it are product managers and external engineers. Owned Ninox’s design system and built its governance with engineering.

One source

Contrast in the algorithm

iOS, Android, web and connected TV — DTCG tokens in four tiers, synced by Style Dictionary

brand themes computed from content artwork, and no theme can ship failing WCAG

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Brand computed rather than policed. Themes are built from content artwork in OKLCH, with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm, so no theme ships failing it.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in four tiers, built with Style Dictionary and platform-agnostic by design, so a new surface is implementation work rather than a system change.
- Standardization and flexibility are held apart by architecture, not by policy. The top two tiers alias downward, so product teams get room on fixed primitives.
- Quality is enforced by the build, not by review: Storybook as the source of truth, and CI rejects an unresolvable token reference or a hardcoded color.
- Adoption reaches past the company boundary.
- The implementation partner builds against the token names, so a breaking change is announced, not discovered.
- No in-house design team, so I own UI quality and consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with nobody to delegate it to. Product managers and product owners build day to day, and an external engineering agency ships from my prototype code across a company boundary.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- An accessibility law landed on the customers, who host their websites on our platform. We audited ours and theirs against the European Accessibility Act.
- Shipped the capability that met it for them automatically, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law. Almost none of these churches have anyone technical.
- Built booking into the platform instead of bolting it on. The same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings, and shipped to every customer. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system, and built the governance around it: a cross-functional working group with a design lead and an engineering lead, and a documented contribution process.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Executive-level mandate in a 100+-person shared-services organization. Turned a services business into a product catalog with the listed group's executive team, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved across the library: what each guaranteed, and where it could be used.
- Five years of enterprise interfaces under regulation, on a platform running under HIPAA among other frameworks.
- Functional head, two direct reports, peer among department heads under a VP of Design. Led the design team across Germany and NYC.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens in four tiers · Style Dictionary · Storybook as the source of truth · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · systems built to hold under AI-assisted work

Governance and contribution

A cross-functional working group with a documented contribution and escalation process · standards other teams build to · an exception register that sets the roadmap · change management across functions

Brand, accessibility and regulated markets

Brand themes computed from content artwork · WCAG contrast validated in code · EU Accessibility Act audits · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · localized products across six markets · GDPR plus church data-protection law · HIPAA

Leading, and senior stakeholders

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the senior leadership team · hired two, promoted two · the Datameer design team across Germany and NYC · design-thinking training for the executive team of a listed group